

Debt Payoff Planner

Thank you for your purchase. Here is everything you need to get started.

Your files

File	What for
Debt-Payoff-Planner.xlsx	The spreadsheet with all formulas. Opens in Excel or Google Sheets. Only fill in the yellow cells.
This guide	Setup in 3 minutes, methods explained.

Google Sheets: drive.google.com → New → File upload → choose the file → right-click → Open with → Google Sheets. All functions used are available in Google Sheets.

Set up in 3 minutes

1. **Debts:** up to 8. Balance, yearly interest rate from your contract, current minimum payment.
2. **Extra per month:** what you can pay on top. Even 50 a month shortens the payoff noticeably.
3. **Method:** Avalanche or Snowball (see below).
4. **Result:** debt-free date, total interest, comparison with the other method and with minimum payments only.
5. **Monthly Plan:** what happens to every debt, every month. When a debt is paid off, its payment rolls to the next one.

Avalanche or snowball?

- **Avalanche:** extra money goes to the highest interest rate first. Mathematically the cheapest.
- **Snowball:** extra money goes to the smallest balance first. You clear a debt faster, which helps many people keep going. It usually costs a little more interest.

Pick the method you will stick with. A plan you give up after three months costs more than either order.

Before you start

- **Emergency fund first:** about three months of expenses, or the next surprise bill lands on the credit card again.
- **Red warning:** a payment that doesn't cover the interest makes the debt grow. Fix that first.
- **Struggling?** Free, non-profit credit counselling exists in most countries. Look for it before any paid debt service.

